

Medicare Advantage vs. Medicare Supplement

The fast, side-by-side way to find the right fit for your client.



Medicare Advantage

Part C - all-in-one private plan

Bundles hospital, medical, and usually drug coverage into one low-premium plan, with extras, in exchange for using a network.

OFTEN BEST FOR

Tighter budgets

Mostly local care

Wants extras



Medicare Supplement

Medigap - fills Original Medicare gaps

Pairs with Original Medicare and pays the gaps, so you can see any doctor nationwide with very predictable costs, for a higher premium.

OFTEN BEST FOR

Doctor freedom

Travelers

Predictable costs

Ongoing needs

WHAT TO COMPARE	MEDICARE ADVANTAGE	MEDICARE SUPPLEMENT
Monthly premium	Often \$0 (plus Part B)	Higher (plus Part B & Part D)
Choosing doctors	Plan network (HMO / PPO)	Any provider that takes Medicare
Referrals & approvals	Often required	Not required
Costs when you use care	Copays up to a yearly max	Very low and predictable
Prescription drugs	Usually built in	Separate Part D plan
Extra benefits	Dental, vision, gym usually included	Not included; buy separately
Travel / nationwide	Best in your local area	Works anywhere in the U.S.
Changing later	Switch yearly at AEP	Anytime, may need underwriting

HOW THEY ACTUALLY WORK

Margaret, 67 - healthy, on a budget

Local in-network doctors, a \$0 plan with dental and a gym, small copays as she goes, capped by the yearly max.

Robert, 72 - manages conditions, travels

Any specialist, no referrals. Plan G plus a Part D plan. Higher premium, near-zero when he gets care.

Questions to ask before deciding

- ? Keeping specific doctors? Are they in-network?
- ? Travel or live elsewhere part of the year?
- ? How is your health? Any procedures coming?

- ? Low monthly bill, or few surprises?
- ? How much do dental and extras matter?
- ? What is comfortable to pay each month?